

BAR FRANCO

Events pack · 2026

EVENTS WITH **FLAVOUR.** *Nights with feeling.*

166 Cashel St, Ōtautahi



01 · Benvenuti, welcome

FROM A TABLE FOR TWENTY TO THE WHOLE BUILDING.

Tell us the date. We'll handle the rest.

THE FOOD

Italian and house-made, pasta included, changing with the season.

THE ROOMS

A Negroni & Spritz Bar downstairs. An open-kitchen restaurant upstairs.

THE HOSTING

A dedicated team runs the night, from the first spritz to last drinks.

NO VENUE HIRE FEE.

You spend on food and drink, and that's it. For exclusive use there's a minimum spend, set by the night and the space. Sunday to Thursday, there's usually none at all.





02 · The spaces

**TWO LEVELS.
ONE WORLD.**

Level 1 · downstairs

NECRONI & SPRITZ BAR

Booths, high leaners and low tables around a lovely big bar. Sheer-draped windows, candlelight, and room for a DJ, a band and dancing.

Seated	80 · more with hired-in furniture
Standing	120

Level 2 · upstairs

THE RESTAURANT

The theatre of Italian cooking, straight from the open kitchen. Long tables, plus a private dining area at the far end.

Seated	90 · 120 with hired-in furniture
Standing	120

The spaces · at a glance

SPACES AT A GLANCE

Every space works for every kind of night. Every event is different, so we tailor everything to you.

Negroni & Spritz Bar	<i>80 seated, more with hired-in furniture · 120 standing</i>
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The Restaurant	<i>90 seated, 120 with hired-in furniture · 120 standing</i>
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The whole venue	<i>165 seated · 240 standing</i>
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Private dining area	<i>Either level · by arrangement</i>
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Group dining	<i>Either level · by arrangement</i>
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Private lunches	<i>Either level · by arrangement</i>
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Smaller groups · lunches

NOT A FUNCTION ROOM. A PLACE TO HOST.

For smaller groups, the bar or the private dining area in the Restaurant.

PRIVATE DINING AREA

A gorgeous table at the far end of the Restaurant, curtained off when you want it private.

GROUP DINING

Soak up the full buzz of the venue. We seat your group together, upstairs in the Restaurant or downstairs in the bar.

PRIVATE LUNCHES

Always available. A long, leisurely lunch, then afternoon drinks in town. Long, slow and very Italian.

The most-loved flow

THREE CHAPTERS INSTEAD OF ONE LONG SIT-DOWN.



Chapter 01

IN THE BAR

Welcome drinks and canapés in the Negroni & Spritz Bar.



Chapter 02

UPSTAIRS

A seated dinner in the Restaurant, with the open kitchen in full swing.



Chapter 03

BACK DOWN

Dessert and dancing. While you dine, we turn the bar into a dance floor.



03 · Food · we cook like someone's coming home

THREE WAYS TO FEED THE ROOM

Custom menus available · all prices exclude GST

01 · Standing

CANAPÉS

Passed on trays. Allow 4–6 pieces per guest.

Best for cocktail functions and after-work drinks.

9/11

per piece

02 · Seated

SHARED FRANCO

Three courses down the middle of the table, served family-style.

Best for team dinners and long tables.

80

per person

03 · The full evening

TUTTO FRANCO

Shared Franco, plus a chef's-choice trio of canapés as guests arrive.

Best for end-of-year and client evenings.

110

per person



Sample menu · changes with the season

CANAPÉS

Passed on trays. Allow 4–6 pieces per guest, or leave the choice to the chef.

BITES

9 each

Goats cheese croquettes, chilli honey *V*

Seasonal arancini, pickled chilli,
parsley mayonnaise *V · GFA · DFA*

Nonna's meatballs, tomato sugo,
parmesan, basil *GFA · DFA*

Market fish crudo, orange,
Sicilian olive, lemon oil *GF · DF*

Oysters, seasonal mignonette *GF · DF*

Potatoes, parsley mayonnaise *GF · DF*

Caprese skewer, bocconcini, tomato *V · GF · DFA*

Melon, prosciutto *GF · DF*

FOCACCIA SLIDERS

11 each

Mortadella, smoked provolone, rocket,
sugo, balsamic onions *DFA · GFA*

Marinated eggplant, smoked provolone,
rocket, sugo, balsamic onions *V · DFA · GFA*
Crostini, whipped ricotta, pickled tomatoes *V*

PIADINI

11 each

Whipped ricotta, pesto, peperonata *V · VA · GFA*

White anchovy, gremolata *DF · GFA*

Prosciutto, stracciatella, rocket,
balsamic glaze *DFA · GFA*

CRAZING TABLE

for the whole room

Per person ... 40

Or a set amount ... 1,000 minimum · 1,500 · 2,000

*V vegetarian · VA vegan available · GF gluten free · GFA gluten free
available · DF dairy free · DFA dairy free available · all prices exclude GST*



Sample menu · served family-style

SHARED FRANCO

Three courses down the middle of the table · 80pp

TO START

Focaccia

Antipasto misto, cured meats, marinated
olives, roasted peppers, pickled onions *GF · DF*

Stracciatella, peperonata, fig and
pistachio agrodolce *contains nuts*

MAINS

Pork ragù lasagne, rocket salad *GFA · DEA*
or seasonal risotto

Porchetta, cannellini
purée, gremolata *GFA · DEA · VA*
or eggplant involtini, dairy-free ricotta

Patate arrosto, parsley mayo *GF · DF*
Fennel and citrus salad, mint, chilli *GF · DF · V*

DOLCI

Tiramisu
Strawberry sorbet *DF · V*

The full evening

TUTTO FRANCO

*Shared Franco, plus a chef's-choice
trio of canapés as guests arrive · 110pp*

ON ARRIVAL

A chef's-choice trio from the
canapés list, passed as guests arrive

AT THE TABLE

Focaccia · Antipasto misto · Stracciatella,
peperonata, fig and pistachio agrodolce

Pork ragù lasagne · Porchetta · Patate
arrosto · Fennel and citrus salad

TO FINISH

Tiramisu · Strawberry sorbet

*Vegetarian and dairy-free swaps
are built in. All prices exclude GST.*



Dietaries · custom menus

NO ONE GOES HUNGRY AT BAR FRANCO.

EVERY DIETARY

Coeliac, vegan, allergies: all of them. Send the list with guest names alongside your final numbers. Each guest gets their own labelled plate and a check-in from the team.

SERVED TO SHARE

For groups, everything is served to share and arranged ahead, so everyone eats together and the night flows. Food isn't ordered on the night.

CUSTOM MENUS

For food and drinks. Tell us what you have in mind and we'll build it. Anything we order in specially is charged in full, for the whole amount ordered.

THE LITTLE THINGS

Pasta, arancini, meatballs or pizza for little ones. Leftovers packed to take home. Printed menus with your logo or a custom heading.

V vegetarian · VA vegan available · GF gluten free · GFA gluten free available · DF dairy free · DFA dairy free available

Nuts in the stracciatella (pistachio agrodolce) · egg in the parsley mayo, left out on request · gluten-free swaps are confirmed with the kitchen before service.



04 · Drinks · charged on consumption

IT STARTS WITH A NECRONI.

ON CONSUMPTION

You pay for what's poured. No packages, no subsidised drinks, and no BYO.

CASH BAR, TOO

Run a tab with a limit, a cash bar, or both. We keep you posted on the spend all night.

MAKE IT YOURS

A house cocktail renamed after you, an Aperol or champagne tower, or bubbles poured and waiting.

THE BAR TAB

Choose 6 wines, 6 cocktails, 4 beers and 4 non-alcoholic drinks. Spirits and mixers are your call.

WELCOME DRINK

Required for 30 guests or more, so no one queues at the bar. The Aperol Spritz rarely loses.

Drinks · pick your tab from here

THE BAR LIST

Choose 6 wines, 6 cocktails, 4 beers and 4 non-alcoholic drinks.

Spirits and mixers are your call. Charged on consumption.

APERITIVO

Aperol Spritz – <i>Aperol, Prosecco, Soda</i>	23
Campari Spritz – <i>Campari, Prosecco, Soda</i>	23
Limoncello Spritz – <i>Santa Marta Limoncello, Prosecco, Soda</i>	23
Hugo Spritz – <i>Fiorente Elderflower, Prosecco, Soda</i>	23
Classic Negroni – <i>Campari, Rosso Vermouth, Bulldog Gin</i>	24
Negroni Sbagliato – <i>Campari, Rosso Vermouth, Prosecco</i>	23
Cherry Negroni – <i>Campari, Cherry, Rosso Vermouth, Bulldog Gin</i>	25
Americano – <i>Campari, Rosso Vermouth, Soda</i>	24
Amaretto Sour – <i>Disaronno, Wild Turkey Bourbon, Egg White, Lemon</i>	25
Franco Margarita – <i>Espolon Tequila, Grand Marnier, Lemon</i>	24
Espresso Martini – <i>Skyy Vodka, Tia Maria, Espresso</i>	25
Boulevardier – <i>Campari, Rosso Vermouth, Wild Turkey Bourbon</i>	26
Olio Martini: Dry or Dirty – <i>Vodka or Gin, Vermouth, Olives</i>	25

BIRRA

Peroni – <i>Tap</i>	15
Peroni – <i>0%</i>	12
BRB Pilsner	15
Menabrea Bionda	17
Menabrea Zero Zero	17

NON-ALC

Sanpellegrino Italian sparkling

Limonata	15
Aranciata	15
Aranciata Rossa	15
Pompelmo	15



VINO

Eight wines pour by the glass on the night; the rest are bottle-only, made for the table. Prices are per bottle.

VINO SPUMANTE

Tallero Prosecco Extra Dry – <i>Veneto</i>	90
Ferrari Brut Trento DOC – <i>Trentino</i>	140
Laurent-Perrier La Cuvée Brut NV – <i>Champagne</i>	165

VINO BIANCO

Mezzacorona Castel Firmian Sauvignon Blanc – <i>Trentino</i>	95
Fantini Primo Malvasia Chardonnay – <i>Abruzzo</i>	85
Vigneti Romio Pinot Grigio – <i>Friuli</i>	95
Vesevo Beneventano Falanghina IGT – <i>Campania</i>	90
Pipoli Bianco Basilicata IGT – <i>Basilicata</i>	110
Mahi Sauvignon Blanc 2025 – <i>Marlborough</i>	85
Dog Point Chardonnay 2023 – <i>Marlborough</i>	120

VINO ROSATO

Fattoria di Basciano Rosato – <i>Toscana</i>	90
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VINO ROSSO

Renzo Masi Chianti Cornioletta – <i>Toscana</i>	95
Fantini Montepulciano – <i>Abruzzo</i>	90
Vigneti Romio Organic Sangiovese Rubicone – <i>Emilia-Romagna</i>	85
Sallier de la Tour Syrah – <i>Sicilia</i>	95
Atzei Saragat Cannonau di Sardegna – <i>Sardegna</i>	100
Ascheri Langhe Nebbiolo San Giacomo – <i>Piemonte</i>	110
Vanita Primitivo di Manduria DOP – <i>Puglia</i>	93
Fattoria di Basciano Chianti Rufina Riserva – <i>Toscana</i>	107
Dicey Bannockburn Pinot Noir 2022 – <i>Central Otago</i>	110



05 · Pricing · all prices exclude GST

MINIMUM SPENDS

FRIDAY AND SATURDAY NIGHTS

Negroni & Spritz Bar *from 4,000*

The Restaurant *from 7,500*

The whole venue *from 15,000*

ANY OTHER TIME

Sunday to Thursday, any space *usually none*

Private lunches *on request*

The host covers the minimum spend through food and a bar tab, arranged ahead. Once it's met, the bar switches to cash.

Drinks bought at the public bar beforehand don't count. November and December are the dearest months, and your proposal gives the exact figure.

No venue hire fee, and all of this

THE ROOM IS YOURS.

INCLUDED

Set-up and pack-down

A dedicated team: one server per 10 guests, plus a manager

Candlelight, low lighting and olive branches

Personalised menus, with your logo if you like

Your décor, name cards and seating plan, set out by us

Projector, screen and handheld microphone

Our sound system, for your playlist, DJ or band

EXTRAS

Cakeage *50*

Security for 18ths and 21sts *at cost*

Linen hire *25 a cloth*

Grazing table *from 40 pp*

Bigger AV set-ups *quoted*

Security is quoted in your proposal. Bigger AV goes through our AV partner. Linen is hired in for you.

Deposits and payments

SECURING YOUR DATE

We pencil your date in while you decide. It goes to whoever confirms first.

TO CONFIRM

A non-refundable deposit, taken off your drinks bill.

Minimum spend		500 +
under 7,000		GST
7,000 to 10,000		1,000 + GST
Over 10,000		1,500 + GST

5 DAYS BEFORE

Final numbers and dietaries are due, and we invoice your food on those numbers. Late additions are welcome; numbers can't go down.

IF PLANS CHANGE

Full terms are in our Venue Hire Agreement.

30+ days out		<i>we keep the deposit</i>
14-30		<i>50% of the minimum spend</i>
days out		
Under 14		<i>100% of the minimum spend</i>
days		

ON THE NIGHT

Drinks are settled at the end of the night, or invoiced after the event, less your deposit.





06 · From first email to last drinks

HOW IT WORKS

01 TELL US ABOUT THE NIGHT

The date, how many, seated or standing, and a rough budget. If it's a milestone, say so.

02 WE CALL, THEN PROPOSE

A quick chat first. Then the right space, your minimum spend and menu ideas in writing, with your date pencilled in.

03 COME IN

Any day from 3:30pm, for a drink on us and a walk through both levels.

04 LOCK IT IN

A deposit secures the date. First to confirm gets it.

START HERE

Send us the date and the numbers · events@barfranco.nz · 021 221 1307

05 SHAPE THE DETAILS

A few weeks out, one simple checklist: food, drinks, numbers, dietaries, timings, music, AV, décor and cake.

06 SIGN OFF YOUR RUNSHEET

Final numbers and dietaries are due five days out, and we invoice your food then.

07 WE HOST. YOU STAY.

From the first spritz to last drinks, our team runs the night so you can be in the room.

PLANNING NOTES

ACCESS

Someone's on site from 3:30pm every day. Decorations, flowers and cake arrive from 3:30pm on the day. Earlier set-up or suppliers by arrangement.

CAKE

Cakeage is \$50, and our chefs slice and serve it on platters (allow about 30 minutes). Bring your own candles. There's no fridge space the day before.

AV

A handheld mic, projector and screen, at no charge (there's no TV). Bring a laptop and HDMI cable, or send the file ahead. Bigger set-ups go through our AV partner.

DECORATIONS

Balloons, flowers, signage, banners and photo booths are all welcome. Vinyl stickers must peel off cleanly. Sharing plates leave little room for big centrepieces.

MUSIC

Our playlist, your Spotify over Bluetooth, or a DJ, duo or band on our sound system.

GETTING HERE

166 Cashel Street, The Crossing.
Take the lift near H&M and Coffee Culture, or the stairs. The Crossing carpark is right there. On request, we'll sign the lift and greet guests at the door.



House rules

THE FINE PRINT

18THS AND 21STS

We host them, a little differently. A security guard is required, charged at cost. Over-18s wear wristbands, which you supply, and ID is checked at the door.

CHILDREN

Under-18s are welcome at private events, with a parent or legal guardian beside them.

TIMINGS

Last drinks at 11:30pm, doors close at midnight. Until then, the night is yours.

CHRISTMAS

We keep it Italian. December books out fast, so enquire early. We're closed from 23 December to 5 January.

GST

All prices exclude GST.

08 · Suppliers we love

FRIENDS OF FRANCO

Bring your own, or lean on the people we already work with.

Flowers *A Little Bit Floral · Tholsie & Co*

Cakes *Full Time Tart*

Live music *Vintage Blue*

Backdrops *Blank Space Events*

AV *Shipleys*

Security *October Protection*

Stay *BreakFree on Cashel · The Observatory ·*
nearby *Crowne Plaza*



Ti aspettiamo, we're waiting for you

SEND US THE DATE AND THE NUMBERS.

Jenna's in Monday, Wednesday and Friday. Can't reach her? Ana-Maria will come straight back to you.

JENNA · EVENTS MANAGER

Monday, Wednesday and Friday

events@barfranco.nz

021 221 1307

FIND US

(upstairs) The Crossing

166 Cashel Street, Christchurch.

Lift near H&M and KOOKAI.

ANA-MARIA · OWNER

Any other day, or if Jenna's away

anamaria@barfranco.nz

COME IN

Any day from 3:30pm

For a drink on us and a walk through both levels.